

Document 16: Merit & Need-Based Scholarship Criteria

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1. Institutional Scholarship Philosophy and the "Single-Benefit" Rule

The Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT) operates a multi-crore institutional scholarship fund backed by alumni endowments, corporate social responsibility (CSR) grants, and university trust funds. The primary objective of this financial aid framework is twofold: to reward exceptional academic brilliance and to ensure that severe economic hardship never prevents a deserving student from completing their engineering degree.

All institutional scholarships are awarded as direct waivers on the Core Academic Tuition Fee. The university does not hand out cash cheques or transfer scholarship money into a student's personal bank account. Furthermore, scholarships only cover tuition; they never cover the mandatory Development Fee, Student Services Levy, or Hostel Mess charges.

The most critical regulation governing the financial aid system is the "Single-Benefit Rule" (No Double-Dipping). A student is legally prohibited from holding more than one university-sponsored scholarship simultaneously. If a student mathematically qualifies for both a Merit Scholarship and a Need-Based Grant, the financial portal will automatically apply the scholarship that offers the higher monetary waiver, instantly canceling the secondary application. State government fee reimbursement schemes (like TS E-Pass) are treated as external scholarships; therefore, a student receiving 100% state fee reimbursement is entirely ineligible to apply for any internal HIT tuition scholarships.

2. The Chancellor's Merit Scholarship (Academic Excellence)

The Chancellor's Merit Scholarship is the most prestigious financial award offered by the university. It is designed to foster fierce academic competition among the student body. The scholarship is awarded dynamically; it must be earned anew every single academic year based on the previous year's performance.

For incoming first-year students, the scholarship is awarded based on entrance examination ranks:

- **100% Tuition Waiver:** Awarded to students securing a TS EAMCET rank strictly below 500, or a JEE Main All India Rank below 10,000.
- **50% Tuition Waiver:** Awarded to students securing a TS EAMCET rank between 501 and 1,500.

From the second year onwards, the entrance ranks become irrelevant. The scholarship is awarded entirely based on the student's Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) calculated at the end of the even semester (May).

Table 2.1: Merit Scholarship Slabs (2nd, 3rd, and 4th Year)

CGPA Bracket	Academic Condition	Tuition Fee Waiver
9.75 to 10.00	Zero active backlogs	100% Waiver
9.50 to 9.74	Zero active backlogs	75% Waiver
9.00 to 9.49	Zero active backlogs	50% Waiver
8.50 to 8.99	Zero active backlogs	25% Waiver

If a student's CGPA hits 9.6 but they failed a minor laboratory course (resulting in an F-grade backlog), they are immediately disqualified from the entire merit scholarship framework for that year, regardless of their high theoretical average.

3. The "Vidya-Dhan" Need-Based Financial Aid Program

The Vidya-Dhan program is engineered to support students who come from severely economically disadvantaged backgrounds, specifically those who narrowly missed the government E-Pass fee reimbursement cutoff but still cannot afford the standard institutional tuition.

To qualify for the Vidya-Dhan 60% Tuition Waiver, the student must satisfy strict economic criteria:

- **Income Ceiling:** The combined gross annual income of both parents (or legal guardians) from all sources must not exceed ₹3,50,000 (Three Lakh Fifty Thousand Rupees).
- **Mandatory Documentation:** The student must submit three highly verified documents: The most recent Income Tax Return (ITR) filed by the parents, a digital Income Certificate issued by the State Tahsildar (Mandal Revenue Officer) generated no earlier than April 1st of the current year, and the last six months of official bank statements for all parental accounts.

The Fraud Verification Protocol:

The HIT Financial Aid Committee conducts aggressive background checks. If a student is found driving a registered four-wheeler to campus, or if their social media profiles display frequent international vacation travel, the committee will launch a forensic audit. If it is discovered that the student submitted forged income certificates or intentionally hid parental business assets to claim the Vidya-Dhan grant, the consequences are catastrophic. The student will be expelled for financial fraud, an FIR will be lodged with the police, and the university will issue a legal recovery notice demanding the repayment of all past waived tuition fees with an 18% penal interest rate.

4. Diversity, Inclusion, and Specialized Grants

To promote demographic balance within historically male-dominated engineering sectors, the university offers specialized diversity grants. These grants operate independently of the general merit and need-based pools but are still subject to the Single-Benefit Rule.

- **Women in Core Engineering Grant:** Any female student admitted into the Mechanical Engineering (MEC) or Civil Engineering (CIV) branches is automatically granted a flat ₹25,000 annual tuition waiver. This grant aims to boost female enrollment in heavy machinery and construction disciplines. To maintain this grant, the female student must simply pass all core subjects; there is no high CGPA cutoff required.
- **Armed Forces Dependent Scholarship:** Children of active-duty or martyred personnel of the Indian Army, Navy, or Air Force are entitled to a 40% tuition waiver. A verified Service Certificate or a Widow/Dependent Identity Card issued by the Zila Sainik Board must be presented during the July renewal window.
- **Orphan and Ward of State Grant:** Any student who has legally lost both parents and does not have an earning legal guardian is eligible for a 100% waiver on both tuition and hostel accommodation. The student must submit an official Death Certificate for both parents and a legal guardianship affidavit to claim this extreme hardship grant.

5. Strict Maintenance and Annual Renewal Criteria

Securing a scholarship in the first year does not guarantee a free ride for four years. The university treats scholarships as a continuous investment in a student's potential. If the student stops performing, the investment is withdrawn. Every student holding a scholarship must submit a "Renewal Application" on the portal between July 1st and July 15th.

To successfully renew any scholarship (Merit, Need-Based, or Diversity), the student must cross strict institutional thresholds:

1. **The Premium Attendance Rule:** While standard students only need 75% attendance to write exams, scholarship holders are held to a much higher standard. A scholarship student must maintain a minimum aggregate attendance of 85% across the entire previous academic year. If their attendance drops to 84.9%, they lose the scholarship for the next year, even if their CGPA is a perfect 10.0. Medical condonations cannot be used to bypass this 85% rule.
2. **Clean Disciplinary Record:** The student must not have a single disciplinary strike on their record. A single warning for late hostel entry, a parking ticket, or being caught without an ID card instantly flags the student as a "Disciplinary Risk," resulting in the immediate rejection of their scholarship renewal application.

6. Immediate Revocation and The "Clawback" Clause

There are specific scenarios where a scholarship is not just allowed to expire at the end of the year, but is actively revoked mid-semester.

If a scholarship-holding student is caught engaging in Level 2 or Level 3 Malpractice during examinations (e.g., cheating with hidden notes), or if they are found guilty by the Anti-Ragging Committee of harassing a junior student, their financial aid is instantly terminated on the same day the verdict is delivered.

Furthermore, HIT enforces a ruthless "Clawback Clause." If a student is permanently rusticated (expelled) from the university for severe criminal violations, drug possession, or violent assault, the university legally retroactively cancels their scholarship from day one of their admission. The student and their parents will be billed for the entire cumulative amount of tuition that was waived over the past years, and the university will withhold all transfer certificates until this massive financial penalty is paid in full.